

MLB News

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September 06, 2026

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LABOR DAY	TUESDAY	WEDNESDAY	THURSDAY	FRIDAY
				
79° / 57°F	82° / 62°F	85° / 70°F	86° / 64°F	77° / 59°F
Sunny	Sunny	Mostly Sunny	Chance Showers And Thunderstorms	Mostly Sunny

McFarlane laments pitch location to Acuña as Phils mull bullpen options in stretch run

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The Philadelphia Phillies' bullpen once again proved to be a house of horrors, squandering a stellar seven-inning, one-run outing from Aaron Nola in a 5-4 loss to the Atlanta Braves. Rookie Alex McFarlane, tasked with holding a 4-1 lead in the eighth, served up a game-tying, three-run blast to Ronald Acuña Jr., who, naturally, savored every single one of his 32.36 seconds circling the bases.

McFarlane's fateful encounter with Acuña involved seven consecutive fastballs, six of which were either at the top of the zone or higher, culminating in a 100.5 mph heater that left Acuña's bat at a blistering 105.9 mph. Acuña, ever the humble slugger, later confessed, "Every pitch was a fastball. I'm looking for a fastball every single [pitch]. I made good contact." McFarlane, for his part, lamented not making his pitch, which, in retrospect, might have involved something other than a fastball.

This bullpen implosion marks the Phillies' seventh blown save in seven opportunities since Game 3 of the 2023 NLCS, a streak so consistent it almost feels intentional. Interim manager Don Mattingly, engaging in some delightful "backseat quarterbacking," admitted that with the result in hand, yes, an offspeed pitch might have been a good idea. But hey, if Acuña had popped it up, McFarlane would have been a hero! The Phillies are now left to ponder who, if anyone, they can trust in October, as McFarlane will undoubtedly get more chances to prove he can, you know, not give up homers in that spot.

Padres hit back-to-back-to-back HRs to start game for 2nd time in franchise history

September 07, 2026

The San Diego Padres etched their name into baseball history on Sunday, launching three consecutive home runs to open their game against the New York Yankees. Fernando Tatis Jr., Jake Cronenworth, and Manny Machado unleashed a barrage of blasts off ace Gerrit Cole, marking only the 12th time in Major League history a team has started a game with such a feat, and a rare second for the Padres franchise.

This wasn't just a power display; it was a personal triumph for Jake Cronenworth, who, after 84 career dingers, finally hit his first opposite-field homer, sending the dugout into a joyous frenzy. "Never thought it was going to happen," Cronenworth confessed, before jokingly declaring the ball was headed straight to the Hall of Fame. Tatis Jr. playfully added, "Only took him seven years."

Yankees pitcher Gerrit Cole, meanwhile, found himself in the unenviable position of surrendering three straight homers to start a game for the second time in his career. While he conceded Tatis's was a "mistake pitch," for the others, he simply shrugged, "They put really good swings on the ball." Machado perfectly encapsulated the audacity: "We hit an oppo homer to right field. We hit one [oppo] to left. And then we hit one to center. Against, again, one of the best pitchers in the game, you don't really see that." The Padres ultimately secured a 4-3 victory, proving that even the most formidable aces can have their day start with a bang, bang, bang!

Yanks drop finale after Cole allows 3 HRs to open game -- for 2nd time in career

September 07, 2026

Yankees ace Gerrit Cole found himself in an unenviable position on Sunday, making Major League Baseball history by surrendering home runs to the first three batters of a game for the second time in his career. This unique, and surely unwanted, distinction came against the San Diego Padres in a 4-3 loss at Petco Park.

Fernando Tatis Jr., Jake Cronenworth, and Manny Machado wasted no time in greeting Cole, launching consecutive blasts on his first 15 pitches. Cole, who previously endured this particular nightmare against the Twins in 2022, simply stated, "They put really good swings on the ball. Sometimes it is what it is." One might imagine his internal monologue was a tad more colorful.

Despite Cole settling down to pitch effectively after the initial onslaught, the Yankees' bats remained largely silent against former teammate Michael King. King, who was part of the Juan Soto trade, extended his scoreless streak to 21 2/3 innings, proving that some breakups are harder than others for the losing party. Manager Aaron Boone expressed disappointment, undoubtedly wishing King had forgotten how to pitch against his old club.

The Yankees did manage a late-game rally, but it ultimately fell short, leaving them with a 3-3 road trip. However, there is a glimmer of hope on the horizon: Aaron Judge is expected to face live pitching soon, potentially returning during the upcoming homestand. Perhaps his bat will be the magical cure for what ails this team, or at least distract everyone from Cole's record-setting, yet utterly forgettable, start.

Acuña relishes boos from Phillies fans as he gets last laugh in villain role with epic HR

September 06, 2026

Ronald Acuña Jr. played the villain to perfection, launching a game-tying home run that propelled the Atlanta Braves to a 5-4 comeback victory over the Philadelphia Phillies. This dramatic win not only extended the Braves' National League East lead but also clinched the season series against their rivals.

Acuña, who openly relishes the boos from Phillies fans, took his sweet time rounding the bases after his epic blast. He even paused for a curtain call, waving to the "irritated" crowd, calling their jeers "motivation." His leisurely 32.36-second trot was his slowest non-disputed homer trot this season, a true masterclass in fan provocation.

The Braves' triumph was a real nail-biter, coming back from a 4-1 deficit in the seventh inning when Philadelphia had a 95 percent win probability. Acuña's heroics came off a blistering 100.5 mph fastball, a pitch Phillies hurler Alex McFarlane simply intended to "attack" with. Clearly, that strategy worked out about as well as a screen door on a submarine, especially considering Acuña's scorching .500 batting average since late August. Austin Riley then sealed the deal with a game-winning triple, leaving the Phillies to ponder what exactly went wrong.